

CASE ID: 197807710339

EPISODE NAME: China–Albania Ideological Split and Aid Cutoff

1978/07/11 - 1989/11/23

Sender: China (710)

Target: Albania (339)

Issue: Retaliate for Alliance or Alignment Choice (7)

Final Outcome: Stalemate after Sanctions Imposition (9)

Summary:

As announced by China on 1978/07/11, and confirmed by Albania on 1978/07/13, China withdrew economic and technical aid from Albania in response to severe ideological disagreement between the two countries' governments.¹ Relations were gradually restored beginning with negotiations in 1983,² and saw a full restoration of economic ties between the two nations on 1989/11/23.³

Narrative:

On 1978/07/13, Albania confirmed that China had officially withdrawn all economic aid and recalled experts posted in the country.⁴ The decision came in response to Albania's personalist dictator Enver Hoxha's criticism of China's ideological moderation in the post-Mao era.⁵

Albania had relied on Chinese aid since the 1960s, when relations broke down between Albania and the Soviet Union.⁶ However, relations with China also began to disintegrate after Hoxha publicly disapproved of China's post-Mao ideological moderation, beginning with a harshly worded editorial in the party newspaper *Zeri I Popullit* on 1977/07/07 and continuing through 1978.⁷ Albania accused China of "kicking against every principle of Marxist-Leninism and proletarian internationalism."⁸

¹ Fraser, John. "Chinese Albanian alliance coming apart." *The Christian Science Monitor*, July 17th, 1978.
<https://www.proquest.com/docview/512004476/CAFF1D151E5C4325PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=Newsapers>.

² "Bilateral Relations," *Albanian Embassy in China*, August 22nd, 2024.

<https://ambasadat.gov.al/china/en/newsroom/marredheniet-dypaleshe/>.

³ "Bilateral Relations," *Albanian Embassy in China*, August 22nd, 2024.

<https://ambasadat.gov.al/china/en/newsroom/marredheniet-dypaleshe/>.

⁴ "Albania Confirms China is Ending Economic Aid." *New York Times*, July 13th, 1978.

<https://www.proquest.com/docview/123635483/A13BD260CC2C4E78PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=Newsapers>.

⁵ Ibid.

⁶ Bourne, Eric. "Albania Snipes at Old Ally, China" *The Christian Science Monitor*, July 21st, 1977.

<https://www.proquest.com/docview/511973199/987DA3EEC9A4A63PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=Newsapers>.

⁷ Ibid.

⁸ "Albania Confirms China is Ending Economic Aid." *New York Times*, July 13th, 1978.

<https://www.proquest.com/docview/123635483/A13BD260CC2C4E78PQ/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=Newsapers>.

On 1978/07/11, China announced that it was ending all economic and technical aid to Albania, and this was confirmed by Albania on 1978/07/13.⁹ Between a few hundred to several thousand Chinese technicians were withdrawn from Albania, with the latter withdrawing the 100 or so students they had studying in China.¹⁰

Tensions began to cool in 1983/05, when China sent a trade delegation to Tirana.¹¹ This warming of relations saw a full restoration of economic ties between the two nations on 1989/11/23, when both nations signed an agreement for economical, technical, and industrial cooperation.¹²

⁹ “China Said to End Aid to Albania; Once-Close Ally Now Harsh Critic,” *The New York Times*, July 12th, 1978. <https://www.proquest.com/docview/123637441/DCCDAEE82584F4APO/1?accountid=14556&sourcetype=Newsapers>.

¹⁰ Ibid.

¹¹ “Country Study: Albania.” *United States Marine Corps*, October 1st, 2009. https://www.marines.mil/portals/1/Publications/Albania%20Study_1.pdf?ver=2012-10-11-163222-127.

¹² “Bilateral Relations,” *Albanian Embassy in China*, August 22nd, 2024. <https://ambasadat.gov.al/china/en/newsroom/marredheniet-dypaleshe/>.